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Comment word FOUNDER

Test your business before you spend a single dollar

A complete beginner's guide to installing the free Founder Skill in Claude and using its AI board of directors, marketing director, CFO and 100 simulated customers to plan your launch.

LEVEL	SETUP TIME	SKILL COST
Complete beginner	About 15 minutes	Free

No coding needed. You only copy, paste and answer questions about your idea.

START HERE

What this guide will help you do

Most new businesses lose money on things they could have found out for free: a price nobody pays, a message nobody understands, or a customer who doesn't exist. **Founder Skill** lets you test all of that inside Claude first.

By the end of this guide you will have installed the skill, described your business to it, had it reviewed by an AI "board of directors", got a marketing plan and a money check from an AI CFO, and run your idea past **100 simulated customers** to see who would buy, who wouldn't, and why.

What’s inside

1. What a "skill" is (in plain English)
2. What's in Founder Skill
3. What you need before you start
4. Install the skill
5. Check it installed correctly
6. Describe your business
7. Your board of directors meeting
8. Your marketing director
9. Your CFO and profit margin
10. The consumer test: 100 customers
11. Turn it all into a launch plan
12. Fixes, checklist and glossary

THE BASICS

What is a Claude ”skill”?

Think of Claude as a very smart assistant who knows a little about everything. A **skill** is like handing that assistant a detailed instruction folder for one specific job: "here is exactly how a CFO checks a business, step by step."

Once a skill is installed, Claude reads that folder whenever your request matches the job. You don't need to remember any special commands. You just talk to Claude normally, and it follows the expert instructions in the background.

Good to know

A skill is just a set of text files (instructions, and sometimes small helper scripts). It doesn't cost anything to run on its own. You only use your normal Claude plan.

THE PACK

What’s in Founder Skill

Founder Skill isn't one skill. It's a pack of **11 skills**, and each one plays a different role you would normally have to hire for. These are the four you'll use most:

STRATEGY

Board of directors

Reviews your idea the way famous founders and investors think, in the style of Alex Hormozi (offers and value), Peter Thiel (being different, not just better) and Steve Jobs (product and simplicity).

GROWTH

Marketing director

Works out who exactly your customer is, what message will grab them, and which channels to use to reach them first.

MONEY

CFO

Checks your prices and costs, finds your profit margin, and tells you where you're losing money and how much you need to sell to break even.

THE BEST ONE

Consumer skill

Creates 100 AI "customers", each with a different budget, objection and buying style, and runs your business past every one of them.

The other skills in the pack cover the remaining parts of starting a business. You don't need to memorise them. Once it's installed, Claude can list them for you (you'll do that in Step 2).

BEFORE YOU START

What you need

YOU NEED	WHY, AND WHERE TO GET IT
A Claude account	Sign up at claude.ai. Skills use Claude's ability to read files and run small tools, which may need a paid plan depending on your account. If you can't find the options in Step 1, check your plan.
The Claude desktop app ***(recommended)***	Download it from claude.ai/download (Windows or Mac). Installing a skill from a link is easiest from the app's **Code** tab.
The Founder Skill link	The link from my reel. It points to the skill's files online.
Your business idea	It can be rough. One or two sentences is enough to start. The skill will ask you questions to fill the gaps.
30–60 minutes	About 15 minutes to set up, then as long as you like to test your idea.

No idea yet?
You can still follow along. Pick something simple like "a home bakery selling birthday cakes in my city" and use this guide to learn how the skill works. Then repeat it with your real idea later.

1 Install the skill

About 5 minutes · choose Option A or B

Option A (easiest, the way I showed in the reel): the Code tab

1. Open the **Claude desktop app** and sign in.
2. Click the **Code** tab at the top.
3. Start a new session. If it asks where to work, choose **Local** and pick any folder, for example a new empty folder called `My Business` in Documents.
4. Paste the prompt below, with the Founder Skill link in place of the yellow text, and press Enter.
5. If Claude asks for permission to download or create files, click **Allow**. It's only fetching the skill's files.

COPY THIS PROMPT — Install

```
Install skill: PASTE THE FOUNDER SKILL LINK HERE

Install it for my user account so it works in every project, not only this folder. When you're done, tell me in simple words where you installed it and whether I need to restart anything.
```

Option B: upload it in Claude's settings

1. Open the Founder Skill link in your browser. If it's on GitHub, click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
2. In Claude (web or app), open **Settings**, then **Capabilities**.
3. Make sure **code execution / file creation** is switched on. Skills need it.
4. In the **Skills** section, choose **Upload skill** and select the ZIP file. If the pack contains several skill folders, you may need to upload each one as its own ZIP.

> **Menus move around**
> Claude's app updates often, so a button might have a slightly different name than in this guide. If you can't find something, ask Claude itself: *"Where do I upload a skill in this app?"*

2 Check it installed correctly

1 minute

Start a **new chat** (skills are picked up when a conversation starts) and paste:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Check

```
List every skill from Founder Skill that you have available. For each one, give me its name and one simple sentence on what it does and when I should use it.
```

You should see a list of 11 skills. If Claude says it can't find them, jump to **Fixes** near the end of this guide.

USING IT

Put your business through the test

Do the next steps **in order, in the same chat**. Each step builds on what Claude learned in the step before, so you only explain your business once.

3 Describe your business

5 minutes · the most important step

The better Claude understands your idea, the better every answer after this will be. Fill in what you know and write "not sure" for the rest. That's fine.

COPY THIS PROMPT — Your business brief

```
I want to use Founder Skill to test a business before I spend money on it. Here is my idea:

What I sell: e.g. custom birthday cakes
Who it's for: e.g. parents in Beirut planning kids' parties
Price: e.g. $40 per cake
My costs (roughly): e.g. $15 ingredients + $5 box and delivery
How I'll sell it: e.g. Instagram and WhatsApp orders
My budget to start: e.g. $300
My goal: e.g. 30 orders a month within 3 months

Before we start, ask me up to 5 questions about anything important that's missing. Then summarise my business in 5 bullet points so I can confirm you understood it.
```

Answer Claude's questions, check its summary, and correct anything that's wrong before moving on.

4 Hold a board of directors meeting

5 minutes

Real founders have a board: experienced people who challenge their decisions. Now you have one too.

COPY THIS PROMPT — Board meeting

```
Use the board of directors skill. Hold a board meeting about my business.

Let each board member (thinking like Hormozi, Peter Thiel and Steve Jobs) give me:
1. Their honest opinion of the idea
2. The single biggest risk they see
3. One change they would make

Then finish with the board's final vote: go, change it, or stop. Explain the vote in simple words.
```

Push back

Don't just accept the verdict. If you disagree, say so: *"I think the price is fine because... Does the board still agree?"* Arguing with your board is how you find the weak spots.

5 Meet your marketing director

5 minutes

COPY THIS PROMPT — Marketing

```
Use the marketing director skill. Based on everything about my business so far, give
me:

1. My ideal customer, described like a real person (age, where they hang out online,
what they worry about)
2. A one-sentence message that would make them stop scrolling
3. The 2 best channels to reach my first 30 customers, with a weekly plan for each
4. 3 example Instagram post or reel ideas I could film this week

Keep it realistic for my budget of $300.
```

6 Let the CFO check the money

5 minutes

A **CFO** (Chief Financial Officer) is the person in a company who looks after the money. The most important number they'll give you is your **profit margin**: how much of each sale you actually keep.

SIMPLE EXAMPLE	AMOUNT
You sell a cake for	$40
Ingredients + box + delivery cost	$20
Profit per cake	$40 − $20 = **$20**
Profit margin	$20 ÷ $40 = **50%** (you keep half of every sale)

COPY THIS PROMPT — CFO check

```
Use the CFO skill. Check the money side of my business:

1. My profit per sale and my profit margin, showing the maths
2. Costs I might be forgetting (fees, packaging, delivery, ads, my own time)
3. How many sales I need each month to break even, and to make $1,000 profit
4. Where I'm losing margin, and 3 ways to improve it
5. Is my price too low, too high or right? Why?

Put the numbers in a simple table.
```

Check the maths

AI can occasionally make calculation mistakes. For any number you'll base a real decision on, ask Claude to *"show the calculation step by step"* and check it with a calculator.

7 The consumer test: 100 customers

10 minutes · the best part

This is the skill that makes Founder Skill special. Claude creates **100 different AI customers**, each with their own budget, objections and way of deciding to buy, and shows your business to every one of them. You get a preview of how the market might react *before* you open.

COPY THIS PROMPT — 100 customers

```
Use the consumer skill. Run my business past 100 simulated customers who match my
target market, with a realistic mix of budgets, objections and buying styles.

Then give me:
1. How many would buy, how many might buy, and how many wouldn't
2. The top 5 reasons people said yes
3. The top 5 objections (reasons people said no), ranked by how often they came up
4. 3 short quotes from the most interesting customers
5. The 3 changes that would turn the most "no"s into "yes"es
```

How to read the results

- **Lots of "no" for the same reason?** That's gold. It's the biggest problem to fix before you launch.
- **The "maybe" group** is where you can grow fastest. Ask Claude: *"What would make the 'maybe' customers say yes?"*
- **Change one thing and test again.** For example: *"Run the 100 customers again, but this time the price is $35 and delivery is free."* Compare the two results.

! Simulated customers aren't real customers

The 100 customers are an educated guess, not a survey. Use them to find problems early and cheaply. Then confirm the most important findings with **5–10 real people** in your target market before you spend real money.

8 Turn it all into a launch plan

5 minutes

Now combine everything into one plan you can actually follow.

COPY THIS PROMPT — Launch plan

```
Using everything from this chat (the board meeting, marketing plan, CFO numbers and the
100-customer test), write my launch plan:

1. The changes I should make to my idea before launching
2. A 30-day launch plan, week by week, with simple daily tasks
3. How I'll spend my $300 budget, line by line
4. The 3 numbers I should track every week to know if it's working
5. A short list of things I should NOT spend money on yet

Write it so a complete beginner can follow it.
```

Keep it

Ask Claude: *"Put the full launch plan in a document I can download."* Then save it and look at it every week.

EXTRA PROMPTS

More things to try

IF YOU WANT TO...	ASK CLAUDE
Compare two ideas	"Run the 100-customer test on idea A and idea B and tell me which one wins and why."
Find a better price	"Test my business at three prices: $30, $40 and $55. Which makes the most profit overall?"
Write your Instagram bio	"Using the marketing director, write 5 Instagram bio options for my business."
Handle objections	"For each top objection, write a short reply I can send when a customer says it."
Name your business	"Give me 15 name ideas, then let the board pick the best 3."

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Fixes

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Claude says it doesn't have the skill	Start a **new chat** (or restart the app), then name the skill directly: "Use the Founder Skill consumer skill to...". If it still isn't found, repeat Step 1.
Can't find the Skills option in settings	Turn on code execution / file creation first, and check that your plan includes skills. Or use Option A (the Code tab).
The answer stops halfway	Type **continue** and Claude will carry on from where it stopped.
You hit a usage limit	The 100-customer test is big. Try 30 customers first, or wait for your limit to reset.
Answers feel too general	Give more detail in Step 3: real prices, your city, your exact customer. Specific in, specific out.

BEFORE YOU LAUNCH

Your checklist

- [ ] Founder Skill is installed and Claude can list all 11 skills
- [ ] I described my business, answered Claude's questions and confirmed its summary
- [ ] I held a board meeting and wrote down the biggest risk
- [ ] I have a clear ideal customer and a one-sentence message
- [ ] I know my profit per sale, my margin and my break-even number (and checked the maths)
- [ ] I ran the 100-customer test and know my top 3 objections
- [ ] I changed my idea based on the results and tested again
- [ ] I talked to 5–10 real people to confirm the biggest findings
- [ ] I saved my 30-day launch plan

WORDS YOU'LL SEE

Mini glossary

Skill	A set of expert instructions Claude follows for a specific job.
Agent	An AI that plays a role and acts on its own, like one simulated customer.
Board of directors	Experienced advisers who challenge a company's big decisions.
CFO	Chief Financial Officer: the person responsible for a company's money.
Profit margin	The percentage of each sale you keep after costs. ($20 profit on a $40 sale = 50%.)
Break-even	The number of sales where you've covered all your costs and start making profit.
Objection	A reason a customer gives for not buying ("too expensive", "I don't trust it").

You just did what most founders skip.

You tested your idea, your price and your message before risking your money. Now go and talk to real customers, and keep using your AI team every time you make a big decision.

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